PREMIUM COURSE MATERIAL

MODULE 3
LESSON 1

Reference Image Workflow

Learn How to Generate SFW Images from Reference Images

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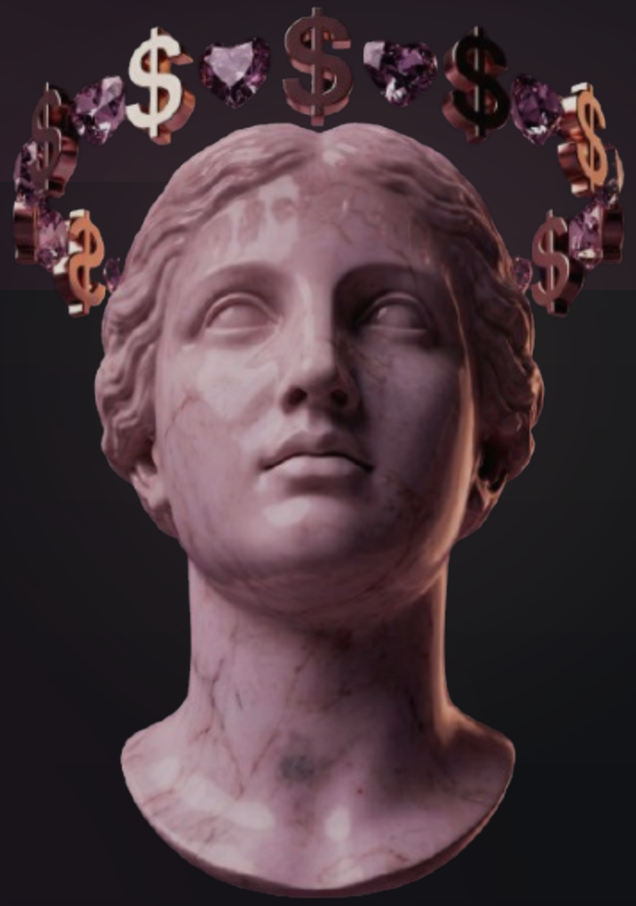

LESSON 1: REFERENCE IMAGE WORKFLOW

Once you have your base model from Module 2, every new image you create should be generated using that base as a reference. This is how you maintain consistency across hundreds of images. The reference image workflow is the backbone of your content pipeline. Without it, every image looks like a different person and your page screams fake.

Both Seedream 4.5 and Nano Banana 2 support reference-based generation. You upload your seed image, write a prompt describing the new scene, and the tool generates output that preserves your character's face while creating the new content. This lesson covers how to use this workflow effectively.

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The Reference Workflow

- → Start with your locked-in seed image from Module 2
- → Upload it as a reference/input image in Seedream 4.5 or Nano Banana 2
- → Write a new prompt describing the desired scene, outfit, or setting
- → Generate multiple outputs (3-5 per prompt) and compare against the reference
- → Only keep images that match the face consistently
- → If the face drifts, increase reference strength or try a different seed angle

Reference Image Best Practices

- Use a clear, front-facing headshot as your primary reference
- Keep 2-3 reference angles saved (front, 3/4 turn, profile) for variety
- Higher resolution reference images produce better consistency
- Never change your reference image once your page is live
- When switching between Seedream and Nano Banana, use the same reference image

IMAGE PLACEHOLDER

Step-by-step visual of the reference workflow: 1. Upload seed image → 2. Write new prompt → 3. Generate variations → 4. Compare to reference → 5. Keep or regenerate. Show example reference image producing 3-4 different outputs.

Choosing the Right Tool for Each Shot

Seedream 4.5 and Nano Banana 2 have different strengths. Knowing when to use each one saves time and produces better results.

- Seedream 4.5 — Best for close-up portraits, headshots, and detailed facial expressions. Strongest at preserving fine facial details
- Nano Banana 2 — Best for full-body shots, varied poses, and lifestyle scenes with complex backgrounds
- For critical content (profile photos, first grid posts), generate with both tools and compare
- For daily content, use whichever tool handles that content type best

Common Mistakes in Reference Workflow

- Using a low-quality or small reference image — always use full resolution
- Setting reference strength too low — face drifts from your model
- Setting reference strength too high — every image looks identical (no variety)
- Ignoring face drift on 'almost good enough' images — never post a drifted face
- Changing reference images between sessions — stick with the same seed

IMAGE PLACEHOLDER

Example showing reference image → 3-4 different output images generated from it, with annotations showing face consistency maintained across different settings and outfits

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